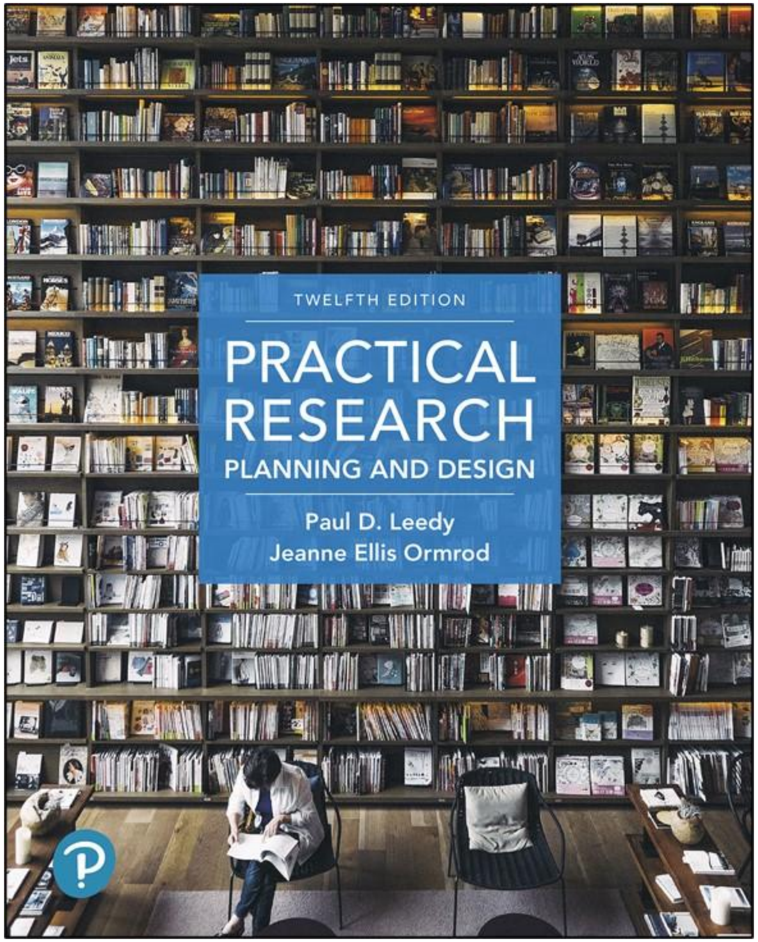
# Practical Research: Planning and Design

Twelfth Edition




## Chapter 9

Mixed Methods Designs

# Mixed Methods Designs (1 of 3)

- Integration of quantitative and qualitative data
- Most useful when addressing the research problem requires both types of data

# Mixed Methods Designs (2 of 3)

- Mixed Methods Researchers should be well-versed in:

1. Identifying focused and useful research questions
2. Formulating and strategically testing hypotheses
3. Choosing one or more samples that enable appropriate inferences about a larger population
4. Controlling for confounding variables
5. Creating and using assessment instruments that have validity and reliability for their purposes

# Mixed Methods Designs (3 of 3)

- Mixed Methods Researchers should be well-versed in:

5. Conducting structured, semistructured, and open-ended interviews
6. Analyzing qualitative data
7. Calculating and drawing inferences from descriptive and inferential statistics
8. Drawing and persuasively arguing for reasonable conclusions from qualitative data

# When Mixed-Methods Designs are Most Useful and Appropriate

- Several good reasons for mixed methods research:
  - Completeness
  - Complementarity
  - Hypothesis generation and testing
  - Development of appropriate research tools and strategies
  - Resolution of puzzling findings
  - Triangulation

# General Categories of Mixed-Methods Research (1 of 4)

- Convergent designs
  - Qualitative and quantitative data collected together, equally weighted
  - Often take a QUAN + QUAL form
  - Can also take an approach that more heavily favors either quant or qual

# General Categories of Mixed-Methods Research (2 of 4)

- Exploratory sequential designs
  - Qualitative phase to get a general sense of the phenomenon first
  - More systematic, quantitative phase based on qualitative data
- Explanatory sequential designs
  - Quantitative phase first
  - Qualitative phase for exploration of quantitative results

# General Categories of Mixed-Methods Research (3 of 4)

- Longitudinal Mixed-Methods Designs
  - Longitudinal studies (recall from chapter 6) follow a single group of participants for two or more occasions over a lengthy time period, perhaps over the course of several months or years.
  - Longitudinal mixed-methods designs incorporate both qualitative and quantitative data collection over a long period of time.

# General Categories of Mixed-Methods Research (4 of 4)

- Multiphase iterative designs
  - Three or more phases
    - Foundational data early
    - Later phases build on early data
  - Example: Program evaluation
    - Baseline data
    - Intervention
    - Data: Did the intervention work
    - Modify the intervention
    - Data: Did the modifications work

# Planning a Mixed-Methods Study (1 of 2)

- Identify research questions and hypotheses
  - should require different types of data
- Begin a literature review
  - May require revision and additions as the study emerges
- Choose appropriate samples
  - Independent
  - Linked

# Planning a Mixed-Methods Study (2 of 2)

- Ensure credibility of the overall research effort
- Consider special ethical issues
  - may need more than one institutional review
  - may need to ensure consent for follow-up phases

# Analyzing and Interpreting Mixed-Methods Data

- Two important considerations:
  - How to weight quantitative and qualitative data when drawing conclusions
  - How to integrate quantitative and qualitative findings for interpretation

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